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Paneer Paratha / Cottage Cheese Bread

Everybody loves paneer, right? Specially when there is a spicy paneer stuffing inside a paratha, I am always up for it. This was my first try on 'paneer paratha' and I just nailed it. Believe me it is much easier than 'aloo paratha'. I made those in breakfast with 'chana masala' and the combo was really gorgeous. Parathas came out perfectly crispy and soft. The taste was unforgettable, we enjoyed them a lot. I'm damn sure that 'he' will request me to make them soon again.



Ingredients

1 cup of crumbled / grated paneer.
4 Teaspoons of chopped onion.
2 chopped green chilies.
1 teaspoon of chopped ginger.
1/2 Teaspoon each of (red chilli powder, garam masala powder, coriander powder and amchoor powder).
Salt.
1 cup of flour / maida.
4 Teaspoons of wheat flour / atta.
2-3 Teaspoons of oil for the dough.
Warm water.
1/2 cup of oil for frying parthas.

Steps

Put the flour and whole wheat flour in a mixing bowl.
Add pinch of salt. Mix them.
Then add 2-3 teaspoons of oil / ghee.

Mix it very well with the flour.

Now gradually add warm water and mix with the flour.

Do not add all the water at a time.

Make a soft dough and knead it well for 5 minutes.

Apply little oil on the surface and cover it with a damp cloth for 15 minutes.

Lets make the stuffing.

Add onion, ginger, green chilies and all the powder to grated paneer.

Mix it.

Add salt to the stuffing and again mix it well.

Check the seasoning.

Take little portion from the dough, make a ball and dip it in dry flour.

Flatten it to 2 inches.

Apply little oil on one side and sprinkle some dry flour.

Put 1-2 teaspoons of stuffing in the center.

Then seal the edges properly, gently press it with your palm and flatten it to 3 inches with the help of rolling pin.

Place the paratha in a hot tawa/pan for 1 minute.

Tawa should be hot not warm.

Flip it and apply 1 teaspoon oil on the surface.

Keep it for 2 minutes.

Again flip it and apply 1 Teaspoon oil on the other side.

Fry it for another 2 minutes.

Then remove it from the pan and make rest of the parathas.

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Mutton Dakbunglow Curry / Mutton Dakbangla

'Dakbunglow' means roadside resting house. Travelers used to take rest or halt for a night in those houses. The care taker of those 'bunglow's cooked this curry for their guests. Nowadays these kind of recipes are almost lost but in a few restaurants in Kolkata you can still find this dish. This is a typical bengali recipe and the tastiest dish ever. Once I ate this curry in my aunt's house and I can still remember the taste. The curry has juicy mutton, spicy gravy, flavorful potato and egg .. do you want anything more ?? It goes very well with plain basmati rice. 'Mutton Dakbangla' will be a great hit for Christmas dinner also. Try this in your kitchen and make your meal a special one.



Ingredients

10 pieces of with bone mutton.
6 Teaspoons of curd.
1 Teaspoon of ginger and garlic paste.
1 big onion thinly sliced.
Whole spices (few fenugreek [methi] seeds, 4 cloves, 4 green cardamoms, 1 bay leaf).
Salt and sugar.
5 tablespoons of mustard oil.
Spice powder (1 Teaspoon turmeric powder, 1 Teaspoon red chilli powder, 1/2 Teaspoon nutmeg [jayfal] powder, a blade of mace [javetri], 1 Teaspoon roasted coriander powder and 1 Teaspoon garam masala powder).
2 pieces of potato.
1 hard boiled egg.
Water.

Steps

Put all the above mentioned spice powder and 2 tablespoons of mustard oil in a bowl. Mix it well.
Add ginger and garlic paste to it. Mix it well.
Marinate the mutton pieces with curd, pinch of salt and this masala paste. Massage the pieces with masala very well. Keep it in fridge for 5 hours or overnight.
Heat the remaining mustard oil in a kadai.
Add few onion slices first. Fry them golden in color.
Then remove them from pan and keep it aside for garnishing.
In the remaining oil add the remaining onion slices. Fry them for 6-7 minutes.
Then add the marinated mutton pieces. Mix it

well for 6 minutes.

Add the potatoes and salt. Mix it and cover the pan. Cook it on slow flame for 20-25 minutes.

Mutton will release lots of water.

Add half teaspoon of sugar to it. Mix well and cook it.

After half an hour you can see the potatoes become fully soft. But mutton needs to cook more.

Boil a cup of water in a pressure cooker.

Add all the whole spices in the boiling water.

In that way the water will become flavorful.

Now add mutton with gravy in the pressure cooker. Keep aside the potatoes.

Give the mutton pressure for 10-15 minutes or until it becomes soft.

If you have time in your hand, skip the cooker process.

When the potatoes become soft, remove them from the pan.

Add a cup of warm water and all the whole spices to the mutton.

Cook it in slow flame until it becomes soft.

Check the seasoning.

When the mutton will become fully soft add the boiled egg. Simmer for just 2 minutes and then serve.

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Koraishutir Kochuri / Green peas Kachori

According to me, winter is incomplete without 'green peas'. Am I right ?? We Bengalis love to eat 'koraishutir kochuri' during winter. In my home nobody brings this kochuri from shop. My mom always makes this at home with 'aloo dom' , 'payesh' and everybody loves it. Nowadays we don't need to wait till winter for green peas because now almost everywhere frozen peas are available. I very much enjoy the combination of fennel, asafoetida (hing) and green peas. This kochuri goes very well with 'dum aloo'. Try this in your kitchen and share some of your winter stories with me.



Ingredients

1 cup of green peas.
2 green chilies.
1 inch ginger.
2 pinches of hing / asafoetida.
Bhaja masala (1 Teaspoon cumin seeds, 1 Teaspoon fennel seeds, 1 Teaspoon coriander seeds, 1 dry red chilli).
Salt and sugar.
Dough (1 cup maida/flour, pinch of salt, 1 Tablespoon of white oil, some warm water).
Oil for deep frying.

Steps

First dry roast the cumin, fennel, coriander seeds and dry red chilli in a pan for 5 - 7 minutes.
Then put them in a blender and grind it to

powder (bhaja masala).

Now put all the ingredients for the dough in a mixing bowl except water.

Mix the dry ingredients first with your hand and gradually add water and make semi soft dough.

Knead the dough very well, apply some oil on top and keep it aside in a bowl with cover for 20 minutes.

Now put green peas, green chilies and ginger in a blender with very little water.

Make a smooth paste. If the paste become coarse, the 'kachori's will not be puffed up properly.

Heat 2 Teaspoons oil in a pan.

Add pinch of hing.

Then add the paste, salt and 1/2 Teaspoon

sugar. Mix it very well for 5 - 7 minutes.

Then add 1 to 2 Teaspoons bhaja masal or dry roasted powder. Mix it well.

When the mixture will leave the pan properly, remove it from the pan.

The filling is ready and let it cool down a bit.

Take a small portion from the dough and make a lemon size ball.

Then flatten it with your fingers and place 1 Teaspoon filling in the center.

Seal the edges properly and again flatten it.

Put the flatten ball in little oil and spread it to 2 - 3 inches with rolling pin.

Heat white oil in a kadai for deep frying.

Put the flatten bread in hot oil.

Press it gently with the spatula, it will puff up.

Then flip it and fry for 10 seconds.

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Crispy Fried Calamari (Squid)

During bachelor life in USA, 'he' went on a trip to Connecticut and had there 'calamari' twice. He just fell in love with the dish. After marriage 'he' insisted me to have fried calamari in a restaurant and I really was not sure about the taste before, so just picked one and put it in my mouth. After that, I, myself finished half of the plate within few seconds. They were that tasty. I wanted to make this calamari for long time, but never got the courage. Last weekend 'he' bought squid from market and cleaned them properly by seeing you tube and told me to make fried calamari. I was really nervous at first but then the end result really satisfied both of us. If you are also a squid lover person like us, please try this in your kitchen and I am sure you will enjoy them too.



Ingredients

1 cup of squid, cut into thin rings.
1 cup of flour.
Salt.
1 Teaspoon black pepper powder.
1 Teaspoon red chilli powder.
Oil for deep frying.

Steps

Wash the squids very well in water.
Then take half cup of flour, salt, 2 Teaspoon oil and some water in a mixing bowl.
Mix them well and make a thick batter.
Put the remaining flour in another bowl along with salt, black pepper and red chilli powder.
Mix the dry Ingredients very well.

Dip one ring in the flour batter first. Coat it well.

Then coat it in dry flour mixture.

Put the coated squid ring in hot oil.

Oil should be really hot.

Fry them till golden in color. It will take 2 - 3 minutes.

Then remove them from oil and place on a tissue paper.

Sooji Halwa / Rava Kesari / Semolina Pudding

The day before yesterday I was craving for some dessert at afternoon. As I didn't have any in my kitchen, had to make it by own. The quickest recipe I found is this one 'Sooji Halwa'. It really takes 20-25 minutes to prepare and tastes awesome. You can make 'halwa' in many colors like white, golden, yellow or orange. But I like my halwa little yellow in color. This was the first time I made halwa at home, really enjoyed while making and obviously eating it !! I love 'rose' flavor in my halwa, you can add cardamom, cinnamon or nutmeg flavors also. Try this in your kitchen and let me know how it turns out.



Ingredients

Little more than 1/2 cup of semolina (sooji).
4 to 5 Tablespoons of ghee / unsalted butter.
2 Teaspoons of chopped cashews.
Some raisins.
6 to 7 Tablespoons of sugar.
1 and 1/2 cup of milk.
Yellow food color / Kesar / Saffron strands.
Few drops of rose water.

Steps

Add ghee / butter in a hot pan and melt it.
Then add chopped cashews. You can add whole cashews also.
Saute it for 2 minutes.
Then add the raisins. You can add almond /

pistachio also.

Mix it for 1 minute.

Then add semolina / sooji in hot ghee.

Mix it and stir it continuously for 10 minutes in slow flame.

Boil the milk in another burner while roasting the sooji.

Now add the boiled hot milk to the roasted semolina. Mix it well for 5 minutes.

Add sugar, color / kesar and rose water in the sooji. Mix it well for another 5 minutes.

Turn off the gas and let it rest for 4 minutes.
Then serve.

Ghee Moricher torkari / Ghee and Black pepper curry / Potato Stew

From childhood, whenever I got attacked by cough and cold, my mom used to feed me this 'ghee moricher torkari' along with some puffed rice / 'muri'. Its nothing but a simple potato curry with mild flavors of 'ghee' and 'morich' / black pepper. According to my mom, the heat of black pepper goes well against cold and cough. Magically my neck always felt better after finishing this mom-made curry. The recipe is very simple but it tastes delicious. Specially you will enjoy this curry during winter along with some luchi (poori) or parathas.



Ingredients

1 large potato, cut into cubes.
2 Teaspoons of ghee.
1 bay leaf.
1 Teaspoon of black pepper powder.
Salt.
Water.

Steps

Heat 2 Teaspoons of ghee in a pan.
Add bay leaf in the melted ghee.
Now add the potato cubes. Mix it well for 4 minutes.
Then add salt and a cup of water. Mix them well. Cover the pan and cook it for 15 minutes.
Then add black pepper powder. Mix it and

cook this untill potatoes become soft.
Check the seasoning and adjust it according to your taste.
Turn off the heat and lastly add half Teaspoon ghee on top.

Mutton Biryani

You always have a grand feeling whenever you pronounce the name 'mutton biriyani'. I mean really I need to describe this? It become the most popular indian dish among the world. Biryani has its own aroma, juicy meat and long grain flavourful rice. But in Kolkata they add boiled potato and egg in their biriyani which makes you more greedy:-) I know that the process is lengthy but believe me you will fall in love with the end result.



Ingredients

Mutton medium size 6-8 pieces.
Basmati rice 2 cups.
Two small potatoes.
One onion sliced.
Ginger and garlic paste 2 Teaspoons.
Curd 4 Teaspoons.
1 Teaspoons red chilli powder.
Biryani masala 4 Teaspoons.(from any indian store).
Cumin seed 1 Teaspoons.
Green cardemom 5.
Six cloves.
One star anis.
One small cinnamon stick.
Yellow food colour / few saffron strands.
Clarified butter/ghee 7 Teaspoons.
½ Teaspoon rose water / kewra water.

Salt and sugar.

Water.

Steps

Marinate the mutton pieces with curd and 1 Teaspoon ginger and garlic paste for 3 hours.
Take a cooker. Heat 4 Teaspoons ghee.
Add sliced onion. Fry it till golden brown.
Then add 1 Teaspoon ginger and garlic paste, biriyani masala and red chilli powder. Mix it.
Shake off the marination and add the mutton pieces. Mix it well for 5 minutes.
Then add all the marination, salt and pinch of sugar. Mix again for 4 minutes.
Then add potatoes. Mix it well.
Now add some luke warm water and pressure this until potato and Mutton pieces are 90% done.
Do not make it too much runny or dry. Make

some thick gravy.

Turn off the gas.

Now wash the basmati rice in cold water very well.

Boil some water with cumin seeds, green cardemom, cloves, cinnamon stick, star anis and 4 Teaspoons salt.

Add the rice in boiling water. Check the rice every two minutes.

When the rice 80% done drain the water.

Now take vessel. Dont turn on the gas. Put 1 Teaspoon ghee.

Then put a layer of mutton with gravy.

Then a layer of rice. Repeat the process twice.

Add 3 Teaspoons ghee, some fried onion, rose water and pinch of food colour on top of the rice.

Cover the vessel with a very tight lid. Turn on the gas and keep the vessel on gas for 20 minutes in medium flame.

Then turn off the gas and keep it uncover for another 10 minutes. After that open the vessel.

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Chicken do Rangeela / Double colored Chicken

First let me thank Disha D'souza for this unique idea. 2-3 weeks ago in a facebook group I saw her unique post and really got inspired. Though I changed the name and recipe little bit (hope she won't mind), but the idea credit must go to Disha. Lots of love and thanks from 'spicy world' to her. Now lets talk about the dish. You can see this is a double colored chicken curry. I also maintain two different taste with the color. I know you are thinking that the process will be lenthly, believe me its not. The taste is phenomenal and goes very well with rice. You can also serve this with naan, paratha or roti. Try this in your kitchen and make your meal a colourful one.



Ingredients

Red colored Chicken:

6 pieces of with bone chicken.

1 cup thinly sliced onion.

1 Teaspoon ginger and garlic paste.

½ cup chopped tomato.

Spice powder (1 Teaspoon turmeric powder, 1 Teaspoon red chilli powder, 1 Teaspoon kashmiri red chilli powder).

1 Teaspoon garam masala powder.

1 Teaspoon sugar.

Salt.

3 Tablespoons of mustard oil.

Warm water.

Green colored Chicken:

6 pieces of with bone chicken.

1 cup thinly sliced onion.

A bunch of coriander leaves.

1 clove of garlic.

4 green chillies.

½ cup chopped green capsicum.

5 Teaspoons curd / yogurt.

1 - 2 Teaspoons black pepper powder.

1 Teaspoon kasuri methi / dry fenugreek leaves.

6 black pepper corns.

Salt and sugar.

3 Tablespoons of white oil.

Warm water.

Steps

First you will need two vessels for this type of cooking. In that way the dish will take very less time to cook.

<div class="descheader">For red colored

chicken:

Heat mustard oil in a pan.

Add 1 Teaspoon sugar and caramelize it.

Then add onion with pinch of salt. Fry it till become golden in color.

Add chicken pieces, all the above mentioned spice powder and ginger and garlic paste. Mix it very well for 6 minutes.

Then add chopped tomatoes and salt. Cook this untill it become mushy.

When the oil starts separate, add a cup of warm water. Cover the pan and cook this untill chicken become soft.

At last add garam masala powder and mix it once.

Turn off the heat and serve this on one side of the plate.

<div class="descheader">For green colored chicken:

Put coriander leaves, garlic, green chilies and capsicum in a blender with little water. Make a smooth paste.

Add curd and little salt in a bowl. Mix it well and then add the green paste. Again mix it.

Then add the chicken pieces in the marination and keep it for 1 hour.

Heat white oil in a pan.

Add ½ Teaspoon kasuri methi and black pepper corn in hot oil. Saute it for 20 seconds.

Then shake off some marination and add the chicken pieces in oil. Fry them for 6 minutes.

Then add onion slices, salt and pinch of sugar. Mix and cook them for 10 minutes.

Now add all the marination. Mix everything well and cook untill the chicken become soft.

If the curry dries out, add little water.

At last add black pepper powder and kasuri methi. Mix it once.

Turn off the heat and serve this curry on the other side of the plate.